

东南康州中文学校之窗

- ◆ On March 31st, Ms. Ninghui Liang, a senior lecturer in the Department of East Asia Languages and Literature of Yale University, gave a training session for SCCS Chinese teachers and some invited parents. Her talk titled Reflection of Teaching and Learning Chinese in America was well received and followed by a lively discussion.



- ◆ We are proud to announce that SCCS has officially become a certifying organization for the President's Volunteer Service Award (PVSA). SCCS can now nominate the volunteers in our school and community, verify their eligibility, and distribute the President's Volunteer Service Awards to them. For more information about PVSA, please visit www.presidentialserviceawards.gov/ or contact us at admin@ctscs.org.

- ◆ On May 18th, Asian Culture Club in Norwich Free Academy (NFA) participated in Celebrating NFA Day. The Club donated all proceeds to SCCS for promoting Chinese culture in our community. Ms. Xiaohui Cao, a SCCS Chinese teacher, and Ms. Waverly Kelley are advisers of the Club.
- ◆ On May 19th, SCCS held its annual Talent Show at ELHS auditorium. Over a hundred students demonstrated their talents in singing, dancing, playing music instruments and other artistic forms. See snapshots in pages 2 and 5.
- ◆ With the close of the Talent Show curtain came the end of 2012-2013 school year. A few teachers will leave SCCS for various reasons. They are Ms. Jing Lin, Ms. Helen Xiong, Mr. Yi-An Bi, Ms. Qiuyin Ren, Mr. Albert Chen, Ms. Lulu

Community News



Farewell Gathering on May 31st, 2013

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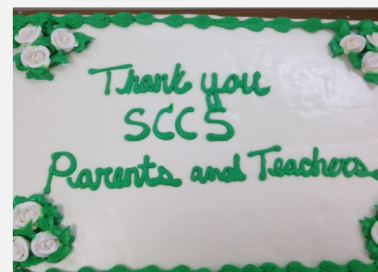
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Zhong, Ms. Tiffany Li, and Mr. Kevin Liang. SCCS held a farewell gathering to thank them for their contributions and to wish them good luck in their future endeavors.

- ◆ Ms. Arianna Xie, an SCCS student, is one of the finalists at the 22nd All-America Youth Contest of Chinese Painting and calligraphy. She is the only one from Connecticut.
- ◆ Alan Pei, a future SCCS teacher, was born at 7:43 pm, May 22nd. He weighs 7 pounds and 13 ounces. SCCS has sent a greeting card to his parents—Mr. Baikang Pei, an SCCS Math teacher, and Ms. Yuxia Mao.
- ◆ On May 29th, SCCS students were invited to perform in a celebration organized by the Asian and Pan-Pacific Group at Pfizer. They are Hanna Hong, Caitlyn Liu, Eric Wu, and Ryan Xu.
- ◆ SCCS students have recently formed a performance group. Since April, the group has performed at four local senior centers, at all of which, they received warm welcome and encouragement from the seniors. Throughout the activities, they have gained first-hand experience of voluntary community services.
- ◆ On June 9th, SECCCS and SCCS jointly sponsored a Summer Sports Day. Over two hundreds local Chinese, SCCS teachers, parents, and students participated in the event.



Seniors were watching the performances of SCCS students



Sports Day and Picnic at Washington Park, Groton



Talent Show—Chinese 3A (Ms. Yinyu Tu)



Talent Show—Chinese 1B (Ms. Xiaohui Cao)



Talent Show—Chinese 4A (Ms. Liurong Luo)

The Best Memory of My Second China Trip

by Ginny White

When I was asked to submit an article about my recent trip to China, I knew I couldn't simply list my itinerary. Many people who attend SCCS have lived in China or have visited China numerous times in the past, and they are much more knowledgeable about the historical and cultural sites than I am. Instead, I decided to write of my impressions as a second-time-around tourist.

Upon arriving in Beijing after a 10-hour flight, we were whisked off to see a local Hutong. As much fun as the rickshaw ride was speeding through the narrow streets and dodging pedestrians and mopeds, we had been longing for a hot shower in our hotel room. However, it was the first opportunity to try out my Mandarin.

I managed to compliment the lady of the house by telling her that her paper cuttings were beautiful. In return, she grabbed my hand and we started a brief dialogue in English and Mandarin about her daughter who lives in New York. I left with the realization that this trip would be more meaningful because of my ability to communicate, even though my Mandarin is a very basic level.

After a few hours of sleep, we started our whirlwind tour of Beijing. In Tian'anmen Square and the Forbidden City, I had a sense of these places being more crowded than they were two years ago. Could the population have grown that rapidly? Of course, I was thrilled to see so many school children on field trips to historic places. We were met by cheerful "hello"s whenever I said "good morning" in my best Mandarin. I noticed that the children's lunches included such items as chips and cookies - just like their American counterparts!

Repair work, painting, and maintenance was being done on the roofs and the decorative trim of the Forbidden City. I was disappointed that my husband was unable to see the insides of many of the major buildings. For safety reasons, many of the buildings were off-limits. However, I am guessing that the last major work was done prior to the Olympics, so it was nice to see that China is maintaining its cultural heritage.

The Temple of Heaven was also undergoing major repairs. However, the park was filled with people playing games that I have never seen. I am hoping to learn "Chinese Chess" and a few other games that I can teach my school children in Westbrook. It was also a delight to listen to music played on instruments I have never seen or heard before. Oh, so much to see and to listen to in such a short time!

Our travel group consisted of twelve adults and nine children. You would assume that the children would be mesmerized by the acrobatic show. You would be correct, but the adults were equally entertained. You could hear "I can't believe..." and "How did they...?" on the bus ride back to the hotel that night, and on the bus on the way to The Great Wall the next morning.

Somehow walking up those steps where millions have walked before and looking across the distant mountain ridges to where the wall seems to go on forever is mystifying. It made me wonder why we need to resurface I-95 every year or so with all our modern engineering and equipment.

Our group of tourists seemed to be the big attraction at The Summer Palace. People were taking photos of us in groups or as individuals. It seems not many Americans enjoy strolling through the grounds and taking a dragon boat ride across the lake. The boat ride was such a peaceful way to end the afternoon. I think it was preparing us for our next excursion.

We boarded the overnight sleeping train to Xi'an. Our cabin barely held all of our luggage, and my boss and I had upper berths about 20" apart from each other. Our husbands slept in the lower berths, trapped in by the luggage. Whenever a bullet train passed ours during the night, our whole train shook. With a few hours of sleep, we lined up in the morning with our toothbrushes at the three sinks in the "wash room". Someone made a comment about memories of summer camp, and I noticed a sleepy smile on every face. I guess we have all been to summer camp!

Seeing the Terra-cotta warriors was worth a few hours of lost sleep. It was hard to take in the row upon row of soldiers, knowing that many more are still waiting to be unearthed. I applaud the archeologists for showing restraint. Rather than dig everything up immediately, they have decided to wait until better preservation techniques have been developed before unearthing more relics. It became a game to try and find two characters that were identical. This one had a different weapon, that one had a mustache. No one was quite ready to leave, but there were more sights to see.

We had an opportunity to experience the Ancient City Wall of Xi'an - the adventurous by bike, and the others by golf carts. My husband and I were in the latter group, deciding to remain in the shade of the cart with a bottle of water, only venturing out in the 80 degree heat to peer over the walls from each watch tower. The city enclosed within the walls looked fascinating and worthy of exploration - if only we had the time. Everyone concluded that we should spend an extra day in Xi'an "next time". We did have a brief excursion through Old



Mr. Ed White was playing Chinese Chess

The Great Wall was as humbling this time as it was two years ago.

Town to the Grand Mosque. Besides experiencing the peaceful atmosphere on the grounds of the mosque, everyone seemed to find something to their liking - vendors, ethnic foods, sidewalk restaurants, and young children to observe and photograph.

That evening we attended an eighteen course dumpling banquet. Each dumpling was shaped like the food item with which it was stuffed. For example, the dumpling stuffed with pork was shaped like a pig, the one stuffed with duck was shaped like a duck, and so on. I believe that my husband set a Guinness Book of World Records performance that evening. I think he actually tried at least one of each type of dumpling. Most of us gave up by the half way mark. Although delicious, dumplings tend to be filling. Several people even succumbed to a nap during the cultural show that followed the dinner.

Before we left Xi'an, we visited the Shangxi History Museum. It was a chance to start putting the dynasties in chronological order and understanding the accomplishments of each.

We had a chance to walk in the central plaza of Jinan one evening. Two years ago the main attraction was flying illuminated kites. This time it was launching a wind-up toy skyward and seeing how high it will fly before returning to you. It was amazing to see hundreds of people, young and old, in groups or individually, enjoying the plaza. They were walking, talking, dancing, and simply having a good time in the light mist that was falling. I keep thinking that we need fewer video games in America and more plazas in our towns for people to gather.

The new Cultural Museum in Jinan continued to help me understand China's history. Now I am able to recognize the names of some of the emperors. I recall having a difficult time remembering U.S. history when I was in school, and I only had to learn about events from 1492 to the present. I can't imagine what a history course in a high school in China would include.

The highlight of our trip came when we arrived at our sister school, Jixia Primary School in Linzi. We were met by cheering students and escorted to a conference room for the official recognition of our sister school program.

Afterwards, students proudly showed us around their school and we were introduced to our host families.

All of the children were immediately accepted as part of their host families. They played games and chatted with the help of translators and translation apps on their ipads and smartphones. The families treated us to fabulous breakfasts and lunches, and they provided transportation to and from the school.

My husband and I were excited to be staying with Du Shaowei and his family. Shaowei had been our guest for four months while he taught at the Daisy Ingraham School in Westbrook. We were warmly greeted by his wife and son, and we were immediately offered a cup of Iron Buddha tea - one of my favorites.

While at the school, the children and I attended classes for brush, painting, ping pong, and paper cutting. It was fun to "chat" with some of the students in Mandarin, praising their work or asking their names. They were quite surprised that I had learned a little Mandarin since my visit two years ago. We also observed the kindergarten classes, and we saw the opening of their field day events.

We had the opportunity to visit the soccer museum and several local industries - a pharmaceutical company, a picture frame manufacturer, and a plastic glove maker. Unfortunately, our visit ended all too quickly - it was time to return to Beijing. With help from strangers, we managed to get all of our luggage and all of the members of our group loaded on the bullet train. With final hugs and tears, we were on our way.

Looking back on our trip, I am still remembering the people we encountered along the way. Whether it was struggling with luggage or language, there was always someone who would come forward to help us. We were met with warmth and smiles and offers of delicious meals. (My husband gained five pounds!)

Perhaps the best memory was when my husband changed "If we return to China..." to "When we return to China..."



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Snapshots of SCCS 2013 Talent Show



Hosts and Hostesses



Chinese 2A (Ms. Chongyang Huang)



Display of Sumi Paintings



Dancing by Hanna Hong and Caitlyn Liu



Chinese 1A (Ms. Ping He)



Dance Class (Ms. Jianmin Sun)



Learning Chinese This way
Victoria Chen/Benjamin Xie/Ryan Xu/Christine Jahn



《Chinese Style》 - Katie Peng



Violin Class (Mr. Yi-An Bi)



Chinese 5I (Ms. Yanyun Chen)



Chinese 4B (Ms. Yujuan Zhai)



Pizza Lunch